Japan Electronic Components: Taiyo Yuden/TDK announce MoU on business alliance regarding MLCCs/inductors and other components

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After the market close on September 29, Taiyo Yuden and TDK announced that the companies resolved on concluding a memorandum of understanding regarding a business alliance focused on electronic components including MLCCs and inductors. Key points are as follows. **(1) Business alliance:** The companies announced that they resolved on concluding a memorandum of understanding in order to proceed with discussions on a comprehensive business alliance, which will center on the joint development of electronic components such as MLCCs and inductors, and also include cooperation in manufacturing and procurement. Going forward, they will proceed with discussions on the details of the collaboration and the division of roles (which are currently undecided), and will also consider the possibility of a capital alliance in the future. **(2) Background:** Against the backdrop of the rapid spread of AI, various technical requirements are increasing, and demand for cutting-edge products is expected to expand rapidly. A stable and speedy response would enhance the competitiveness and growth potential of both companies, and could also contribute to strengthening Japan's industrial base.

Bottom line, we think there are three implications.

First, this announcement can be complementary for both Taiyo Yuden and TDK. In MLCCs, TDK has a long history in automotive applications and is very strong in high-voltage products. Taiyo Yuden has a long history in PC/smartphone applications and is very strong in compact, high-capacitance products. They have a mutually complementary relationship for AI servers. On the other hand, in inductors, TDK has strengths in its technological capabilities, including a wide lineup from small to large sizes and thin-film technology. Taiyo Yuden concentrates on compact, high-end products and has strengths in multilayer/metal-based products. We believe this would be a complementary relationship. Because they are in a competitive relationship with each other, we need to closely monitor the specific details and timeframe of the collaboration, but we perceive this as a logical alliance in the sense of not missing out on business opportunities (opportunities to provide products) due to rapid technological changes.

Second, if viewed as an indicator of broader industry consolidation to come, we would see it as a positive move for the overall MLCC/inductor industry in the sense of strengthening the position of suppliers. Although it is currently at the initial stage of a Memorandum of Understanding for a business alliance, if there were to be broader industry realignment further down the line, it is possible to view this positively in terms of investment efficiency, production capacity, and the balance of

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power between customers and suppliers.

Third, the implications for Murata and Kyocera. We think this should not be viewed as particularly negative for Murata Mfg. With technological evolution progressing rapidly and a demand > supply situation continuing, we judge that Murata's position of enjoying the industry profit pool the most remains unchanged. For Kyocera, on the other hand, there is a tendency to specialize in specific areas/fields of MLCCs, and we assume it will continue with its independent strategic path going forward.

Price Target Risks and Methodology

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Taiyo Yuden
Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on Taiyo Yuden with a 12-month price target of ¥21,300. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (our TP implies FY3/29E P/E of 31X).

Key risks: Weaker-than-expected smartphone demand, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - TDK
Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on TDK with a 12-month price target of ¥4,900. Our target price is based on a FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 10% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 10X (implies FY3/28E P/E of 27X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, higher input costs, and yen appreciation.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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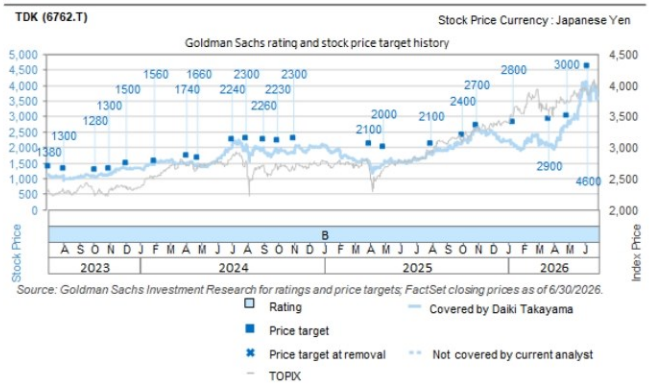
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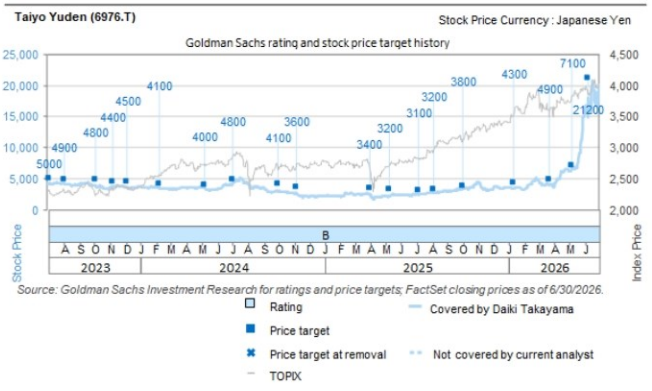
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Target price history table(s)

Taiyo Yuden (6976.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
05-Aug-26	21,300	11,165
08-Jun-26	21,200	14,975
08-May-26	7,100	6,663
23-Mar-26	4,900	3,926
12-Jan-26	4,300	3,405
02-Oct-25	3,800	3,382
05-Aug-25	3,200	2,841
07-Jul-25	3,100	2,488
09-May-25	3,200	2,202
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,467
07-Nov-24	3,600	2,781
01-Oct-24	4,100	3,081
02-Jul-24	4,800	4,105
08-May-24	4,000	3,643
07-Feb-24	4,100	3,431
06-Dec-23	4,500	3,627
07-Nov-23	4,400	3,695
04-Oct-23	4,800	3,963

TDK (6762.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-26	4,900	3,008
08-Jun-26	4,600	3,715
28-Apr-26	3,000	2,677
23-Mar-26	2,900	2,043
12-Jan-26	2,800	2,142
31-Oct-25	2,700	2,673
02-Oct-25	2,400	2,154
01-Aug-25	2,100	1,876
28-Apr-25	2,000	1,460
31-Mar-25	2,100	1,546
01-Nov-24	2,300	1,848
01-Oct-24	2,230	1,948
02-Sep-24	11,300	2,023
30-Jul-24	11,500	2,029
02-Jul-24	11,200	2,004
26-Apr-24	8,300	1,462
03-Apr-24	8,700	1,488
31-Jan-24	7,800	1,488
06-Dec-23	7,500	1,338
01-Nov-23	6,500	1,158
04-Oct-23	6,400	1,052

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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